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Richard Neave

Cloud Platform Engineering Lead

Profile

Cloud Platform Engineering Leader with extensive experience driving the strategy, architecture, and delivery of enterprise-scale cloud solutions. Proven ability to build, lead, and drive high-performing teams, aligning technology initiatives with business objectives to deliver measurable improvements. Brings deep expertise in DevOps practices and cloud-native technologies while maintaining a focus on governance, cost optimization, security, and operational excellence. Passionate about fostering innovation, developing future leaders, and guiding organizations through complex cloud transformation initiatives.

Experience

September 2024 - Present

Engineering Lead (Public Cloud), *Lloyds Banking Group*, London

- Manage and maintain existing Azure and Google Cloud IaaS landing zones, ensuring stability, compliance, and performance.
- Design and build new cloud-native landing zones on Azure and Google Cloud to support modern application and infrastructure needs.
- Lead the recruitment and onboarding of skilled Cloud and DevOps engineers, building a high-performing, collaborative engineering team.
- Manage and provide technical direction across multiple engineering feature teams, ensuring consistent delivery, architectural alignment, and quality standards.
- Plan and implement cloud platform consolidation strategies to reduce the number of landing zones and toolsets, resulting in cost savings and simplified operations.
- Focus on platform governance, automation, and security, enabling scalable and compliant multi-cloud environments.
- Support ongoing cloud transformation initiatives, ensuring technical excellence and alignment with organizational goals.

October 2023 - September 2024

Associate Director, *Cognizant*, London, (Retail Banking Client)

- Transitioned into a new role following Contino's integration into Cognizant Consulting, retaining Engineering Lead responsibilities for a major UK retail banking client.
- Continue to provide technical leadership and strategic guidance across multiple high-velocity projects, with a focus on emerging Azure technologies including Azure AI and Azure Arc.
- Work closely with cross-functional teams to accelerate digital transformation, ensuring modern cloud-native architectures meet both business goals and regulatory requirements.
- Maintain role as escalation point for complex engineering issues, while supporting architecture governance, stakeholder engagement, and engineering delivery consistency.

April 2022 - October 2023

Senior Technical Principal, *Contino*, London, (Retail Banking Client)

Engineering Team Lead

- Lead engineer across multiple cloud and automation workstreams for a major UK retail banking client, serving as the final escalation point for engineering decisions and complex technical challenges.
- Provide guidance and oversight to engineering teams on client expectations, delivery processes, and technical architecture, ensuring alignment with business goals and compliance requirements.
- Coordinate cross-functional teams, including client stakeholders and suppliers (e.g., Microsoft), to drive new engineering proposals and resolve multi-party infrastructure and design issues.

Client Engagement & Stakeholder Management

- Deliver technical overviews and solution walkthroughs to senior stakeholders and business teams.
- Represent engineering in client architecture governance forums, presenting and defending proposed designs against security, compliance, and strategic criteria.

Security, Risk & Compliance

- Ensure all engineering deliverables meet regulatory and compliance controls, working closely with client security teams to assess and mitigate technology and process risks.
- Produce documentation and evidence packs to support audit-readiness and governance reviews.

People Leadership & Talent Development

- Support engineering team members with career development, training plans, and day-to-day mentorship.
- Conduct technical interviews and help shape the hiring process to ensure high engineering standards across the account.

October 2019 - April 2022 **Principal Consultant**, *Contino*, London, (Retail Banking Client)

Compute Architecture & Governance (Azure)

- Designed and implemented a compute pattern using Azure Virtual Machines, integrated with Azure Backup, Automation, Update Management, and Azure Policy to enforce strict client governance and compliance requirements.
- Led a security-first approach, conducting in-depth evaluations of encryption methods for data at rest and in transit, ensuring alignment with regulatory standards and client policies.

Cloud Datacenter – Storage Architecture

- Architected the initial cloud landing zone using a hub-and-spoke topology, aligning with Azure best practices for scalability and isolation.
- Designed and implemented a robust storage strategy utilizing Azure Blob Storage, File Storage, and Data Factory for data orchestration.
- Created Low-Level Design (LLD) documentation to evidence compliance with governance and control standards.

On-Prem to Cloud Storage Assessment & Strategy

- Conducted a comprehensive assessment of the client's on-premises storage infrastructure, analyzing data types, usage patterns, and compliance needs.
- Delivered a detailed Azure migration strategy, recommending suitable storage services and outlining a data classification and migration plan to support a secure and seamless transition to the cloud.

November 2016 - October 2019 **Automation Team Manager (Europe)**, *IPsoft*, London, (Retail Banking Client)

- Led the European Automation Team, responsible for development and delivery of enterprise-scale automations on IPcenter (ITSM platform) and 1Desk, the next-generation autonomic operations tool.
- Spearheaded a strategic project, commissioned by the European CEO, to containerize the IPcenter platform using Docker and deploy it with Kubernetes (Helm)—delivered successfully within a 2-month timeframe.
- Developed a lightweight, modular automation engine with seamless AWS provisioning, supporting client-specific customizations and pre-built automations.
- Integrated with ElasticSearch and Kibana to enable real-time visibility of automation activity and system health via dynamic dashboards.
- Proposed and implemented a global automation standardization initiative, introducing consistent development, documentation, and QA practices across teams.
- Adopted Python Sphinx (reStructuredText) for documentation and built automated QA reporting tools to streamline engineer workflows.
- Resulted in highly portable, supportable automations across clients, reducing onboarding time and enhancing maintainability.

May 2015 - November 2016 **Senior Automation Engineer**, *IPsoft*, London, (Media Agency Client)

- Acted as a primary liaison between technical teams and clients, gathering requirements and delivering high-impact automations aligned with both client requests and proactive insights derived from event data analysis using Jupyter.
- Managed work via JIRA Agile boards with integrated Bitbucket repositories for source control and code review processes.

May 2013 - May 2015 **DevOps Engineer**, *Star Financial Systems*, London, (Internal)

- Designed, built, and maintained VMware-hosted QA environments and data center production servers.
- Automated QA build provisioning using PowerShell (PowerCLI) on Windows Server 2008R2, with TeamCity for CI/CD (builds and unit testing) and Octopus Deploy for automated application deployment and MSSQL backups.
- Reduced deployment time to production from over 6 hours to under 30 minutes using a combination of Octopus Deploy and PowerShell scripts—supporting 30+ microservices across 5+ Windows hosts.
- Utilized PowerCLI for on-demand provisioning of standardized test environments, ensuring QA/dev closely mirrored production setups, enabling faster debugging and release validation.
- Integrated Slack APIs to deliver real-time notifications for all deployments and monitoring alerts, including Nagios production environment warnings for client-facing systems.

August 2012 - May 2013 **Senior 2nd Line Support Engineer**, *GroupM*, London, (Internal)

Project work including the provisioning of around 400-laptops using Symantec Ghost, then installation of all required user and support software using LANDesk. All hardware/software was deployed successfully within a tight delivery window.

Provided IT support for C-level staff using Windows & Mac OS X operating systems. This also included providing technical support for off-site client presentations by senior management.

August 2009 - August 2012 **2nd Line Support Engineer**, *GroupM*, London, (Internal)

Providing second line support to GroupM (and sub-company) staff for all escalated desktop support incidents. This included hardware and Windows OS support, as well as troubleshooting for in house and enterprise media booking applications.

May 2009 - July 2013 **Rifleman**, *British Army (Reserves), The Rifles Regiment*, London
Completed monthly weekend and annual two-week training programs, enhancing teamwork, discipline, and organizational skills in high-pressure environments. Developed strong collaborative and leadership abilities through structured military training and field exercises.

Technologies

Cloud	Azure, Google	Kubernetes	Istio, OPA, AquaSec, Helm, Cert-Manager
CI/CD	Jenkins, Teamcity, Octopus Deploy, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Terraform Cloud	Infrastructure	Windows, macOS, Linux (Ubuntu, Redhat)
Interpreted languages	Python, PowerShell, JavaScript, Bash	Compiled languages	Golang
Virtualization	Docker, Azure VMware Solution, VMWare vSphere, Kubernetes	Documentation	Sphinx, reStructuredText, Markdown, LaTeX
Reporting/Analysis	Jupyter, Elastic Search, Kibana	Other	RegEx, Vim, Tmux

Education

September 2005 - July 2008 **Northumbria University**
Bsc (Hons):
- Product Design Technology: *Second*

September 2000 - July 2005 **Harrow School**
A-Level:
- Information Communication Technology: *A*
- Design Technology: *B*
- Business Studies: *B*

AS-Level:
- Photography: *A*

GCSE:
- Maths, Geography, Design Technology, History: *A*
- French, English Language & Literature, Chemistry, Physics, Religious Studies: *B*